Peeling strips (Rainbow eucalyptus)

Mottled
(American sycamore)

Blotchy bark *flakes off in large chunks.*

Flaking
(Pine)

Thick outer bark *peels off to reveal soft inner bark.*

Diamond-shaped pores *join each other to form channels in older trees.*

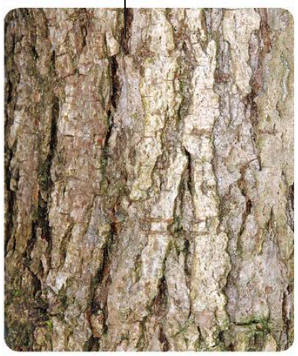
Diamond lenticels
(White poplar)

Horizontally broken ridges (English oak)

English oak bark *contains tannins, which are chemicals used in making leather.*

In some **Aboriginal Australian** stories, ghost gums are **living spirits**.

Deep cracks *develop in the bark as the tree ages.*



Intersecting ridges
(Crack willow)

Rough lenticels *break up the shiny, coppery brown bark.*

Horizontal lenticels
(Tibetan cherry)

White
(Ghost gum)

Powdery, white bark *reflects the heat of the strong Australian sun.*

survive, trees such as **white poplar** and **Tibetan cherry** develop spongy cracks called lenticels in their bark to let air pass through. Some bark naturally splits as the tree grows, revealing the inner layer beneath. This produces beautiful patterns on the **Manchurian striped maple**, the **rainbow eucalyptus**, and the **American sycamore**. Trees can die if their bark is severely damaged. Mountain pine beetles can introduce a fungus under the bark of a **pine** tree to weaken it, allowing their eggs to hatch and the larvae to eat the living layer under the bark. The pine tree releases sticky resin to defend itself against these insects.